HOU +2.5 @ JAX — Week 6 2026

Read: HOU +2.5 is the side. Rank 5 of 24 on the combined board, score 97, 17 cells for and 6 against. Total 42.5 is a pass. Moneyline +124 is the alternate given four one-score HOU losses. Line JAX –2.5 / total 42.5 (nflverse, Oct 18). Stats, game flow, turnovers and pressure only; no scheduling inputs.

1. Why HOU

Dog composite +12 toward HOU, the largest on the slate. The ≥ +7 band is 146-75 ATS, 66.1%, games 4–7, 2015–2025. Eight of the twelve composite cells are JAX-as-favorite fades off JAX's own season profile: the market-overprices-early-season-defense finding, with every version of it firing at once.

Favors	Cell	%
HOU	HOU: competitive snaps + 4th-down stack	64.0
HOU	HOU: early ATS margin bottom quintile	60.8
HOU	HOU: top pressure D as dog	57.9
HOU	HOU: L2 pressure differential top quintile (+14), 9/11 seasons	57.0
HOU	JAX: blown 80% WP lead as fav	41.6
HOU	JAX: hot offense as fav	42.0
HOU	JAX: QB-adjusted best pass D quintile as fav, 1/11 seasons	42.3
HOU	JAX: 4th-down attempts bottom quintile	42.3
HOU	JAX: best pass D quintile raw as fav	42.9
HOU	JAX: hot offense + hot ATS stack as fav	43.0
HOU	JAX: early ATS margin top quintile as fav	43.4
HOU	JAX: TO margin ≥ +4 as fav	44.1
HOU	JAX: FAV screen, best overall D quintile	44.6
HOU	JAX: FAV screen, fewest rush yds allowed quintile	44.8
HOU	HOU: rush matchup bottom quintile (back)	53.5
HOU	JAX: TREND off yards ≥ 400 last, fav now	46.2
HOU	JAX: TREND net EPA ≥ +10 last, fav now	46.7
JAX	JAX: FLOW won with exactly 1 ugly marker (late steal), fav now, 9/11	57.4
JAX	JAX: FLOW my ugly win vs opp off a win, fav now	59.1
JAX	JAX: FLOW both off ugly wins, favorite side	60.7
JAX	HOU: FLOW ugly win (TO-fueled) as fav last game, dog now	44.2
JAX	HOU: FLOW opp had ugly win, I am the dog	42.9
JAX	JAX: FAV screen, worst CPOE allowed quintile	54.5

Blue rows favor HOU, orange rows favor JAX. Flow is the only family on JAX's side (net –5 against HOU). It loses to the composite on breadth and on historical hit rate: 66.1% at ≥ +7 vs 57–61% for the flow cells.

2. Season profile through week 5 (rank of 32)

Stat	HOU	JAX
Off EPA / play	+0.020 (12)	+0.156 (5)
Pass EPA / play	+0.110 (12)	+0.301 (3)
Rush EPA / play	–0.153 (27)	+0.009 (9)
Off success rate	.429 (15)	.473 (8)
Def EPA / play	–0.044 (10)	–0.094 (3)
Def success rate	.388 (3)	.417 (10)
Def pass EPA	+0.010 (18)	–0.077 (4)
Def rush EPA	–0.134 (8)	–0.195 (1)
Sack rate generated	8.4% (4)	5.9% (15)
QB hit rate generated	16.0% (14)	15.3% (16)
Sack rate allowed	6.7% (23)	6.1% (17)
CPOE allowed	+0.4 (13)	+4.6 (27)
3rd-down conversion	38.6% (18)	48.1% (5)

Stat	HOU	JAX
Competitive-snap share	.766 (5)	.594 (25)
Rush yds / game	79 (31)	115 (14)
Rush yds allowed / game	79 (3)	64 (1)
Total yds / game	341 (13)	336 (15)
ST EPA / game	–0.41 (28)	+1.08 (16)
Penalties / game	8.4 (24)	8.0 (21)
TO margin (season)	+3 (9)	+5 (2)
Avg margin	–0.4 (18)	+10.6 (2)
ATS	1-4 (30)	3-2 (10)

JAX is 3rd in def EPA, 4th vs the pass, 1st vs the run, +5 turnover margin, 4-1, 3-2 ATS with a top-quintile ATS margin. Each of those is a fade cell as a favorite. JAX allows the 27th-ranked CPOE, so the pass defense graded 4th by EPA is built on explosive suppression and takeaways, not coverage. HOU is 5th in competitive-snap share, JAX 25th: HOU's games stay close, JAX's have been decided early. HOU is 4th in sack rate against a JAX line allowing 6.1%, the pressure cell that hit 9 of 11 seasons. HOU's offense is the liability, 31st rushing and 27th in rush EPA; the rush-matchup cell backs HOU anyway because JAX's run defense is the unit most likely to regress.

3. Game log

Team	Wk	Game	Line	Result	ATS	Off EPA	Def EPA	Sacks	Sacks taken	Yds	Rush	Rush allowed
HOU	1	vs BUF	–1.5	L 31-36	miss	+0.07	+0.23	2	3	381	124	87
HOU	2	vs CIN	+3.0	L 6-20	miss	–0.25	–0.09	5	4	374	60	86
HOU	3	at IND	+1.5	L 17-19	miss	–0.09	–0.11	4	3	223	70	89
HOU	4	vs DAL	+3.0	L 30-34	miss	+0.24	+0.14	3	2	397	62	75
HOU	5	at TEN	+6.5	W 26-3	cover	+0.13	–0.39	4	2	331	81	57
JAX	1	vs CLE	+8.5	W 34-10	cover	+0.34	–0.18	5	1	363	129	87
JAX	2	at DEN	–2.5	L 13-20	miss	–0.05	+0.12	0	2	268	95	107
JAX	3	vs NE	+3.0	W 35-6	cover	+0.23	–0.25	3	1	315	137	83
JAX	4	at CIN	–2.5	W 22-17	cover	+0.19	+0.05	2	4	325	113	23
JAX	5	vs PHI	+7.5	W 19-17	miss	+0.06	–0.20	1	2	408	102	22

Line column is the team's own number, positive = favorite. HOU's four losses are by 5, 14, 2 and 4. JAX's last game: won by 2 as a 7.5-point favorite, trailed at 5:00 (late-steal marker). HOU's last game: 23-point win with turnover WPA gained ≥ +0.30 (TO-fueled marker).

4. Total 42.5: pass

O/U	Cell	Over %
O	two best defenses by EPA	55.2
O	most penalized pair	54.8
O	both going under early	53.4
U	two hot offenses	43.1
U	TREND both net EPA ≥ +10 last game	41.6

Net +1 after the trend cell, below the +2 threshold (over 55.8%) and nowhere near –2 (under 59.0%).

5. Havoc

HOU 15th of 28 defenses on the slate: 2.5 expected sacks, 1.1 expected takeaways, 31% chance of 5+ havoc plays. JAX 14th: 2.4 sacks, 1.3 takeaways. HOU has the better raw rush (18 sacks, 8.4%, 24.8% pressure rate) but JAX runs the fewest dropbacks on the slate at 32.6 per game, which caps the count.

6. Entry and invalidation

Entry HOU +2.5; +124 moneyline as the alternate. Invalidation: none pre-kick. This is a composite play at the largest net on the slate and the number is the number.